

Thursday, 27 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Showers 25° 18°	BIRMINGHAM Heavy rain 22° 17°	MANCHESTER Showers 19° 16°	GLASGOW Overcast 21° 16°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

A murder investigation has been launched after two people died in a house fire near Middlesbrough.

Cleveland Police say they are keeping an open mind but "cannot rule out any links to wider organised crime" in connection with the blaze. Emergency services were called to the property in the early hours of Wednesday morning.

CRIME · UK
- 2

Household energy bills are set to hit a three-year high this autumn, with Ofgem announcing a 4% rise from October.

The energy regulator says a typical household using gas and electricity will pay around £60 more a year. This increase comes as many families are already struggling with the cost of living.

COST OF LIVING · UK
- 3

Yellow weather warnings remain in force across parts of the UK as heavy rain and thunderstorms continue to cause disruption.

Torrential downpours are affecting areas of England and Wales, bringing some of the wettest weather seen in several weeks. Drivers are being urged to take extra care on the roads.

WEATHER · UK
- 4

The father of a woman who took her own life says the Treasury failed in its duty of care.

Chloe Moffat died last year after being told of allegations she had shared sensitive confidential information about colleagues, which she denied. Her father believes more could have been done to support her.

MENTAL HEALTH · UK
- 5

An investigation has been launched into a former chief constable and three other officers over the banning of Israeli football fans.

Craig Guildford, along with three police officers and a staff member, are facing an Independent Office for Police Conduct investigation. The allegations relate to a decision made during a European football fixture.

POLICE · UK

What's coming up

1

Hollywood stars Nicole Kidman and Sandra Bullock have been spotted filming the sequel to 'Practical Magic' on an Essex vintage train.

The actresses were seen on a specially transported train at a film studio for the new movie. Fans are eagerly anticipating the return of the beloved witches.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of 'Practical Magic'? What are your hopes for the sequel?

FILM · COMING UP

2

The Netflix hit series 'Dept Q' is back in Edinburgh, with filming for its second season well underway.

The cast and crew returned to the Scottish capital in June and are expected to continue filming until October. Fans can look forward to more gripping mysteries from the popular show.

ON AIR – Have you watched 'Dept Q'? What's your favourite detective series on Netflix?

TV · COMING UP

3

Rockstar Games has finally broken its silence on the 'Grand Theft Auto 6' leaks, admitting the unauthorised footage caused "heartbreak" for the team.

The game developer acknowledged the impact of the leaks on those working tirelessly on the highly anticipated title. Despite the setback, development is continuing.

ON AIR – Are you excited for Grand Theft Auto 6? Do you think game leaks spoil the surprise?

GAMING · COMING UP

4

Songs created by Artificial Intelligence have been officially banned from Australia's music charts.

This move comes just weeks after a DJ admitted using AI to remix a Madonna song that topped the Australian charts. It raises big questions about the future of music.

ON AIR – Should AI-generated music be allowed on the charts? What does this mean for human artists?

MUSIC · FUTURE

5

Workers at three Victoria and Albert Museum sites are set to strike over ongoing disputes concerning pay and conditions.

Further staff also plan to work to rule, potentially impacting visitors to the iconic cultural institutions. Discussions are ongoing to resolve the issues.

ON AIR – Have you visited the V&A recently? What's your favourite museum in the UK?

CULTURE · THIS WEEK

On the schedule

1 **Manchester City have completed the signing of Morocco midfielder Ayyoub Bouaddi from Lille in a massive £85.6 million deal.**

The 18-year-old has signed a five-year contract with the Premier League champions. City beat off strong competition to secure the highly-rated youngster.

ON AIR – Another big signing for City! Can anyone stop them this season?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Manchester United captain Bruno Fernandes and Manchester City forward Khadija Shaw have won the prestigious PFA Player of the Year awards.**

Fernandes was named the men's player of the year, while Shaw scooped the women's award for the second time in three seasons. Both players had exceptional campaigns.

ON AIR – Do you agree with the PFA's choices? Who would have been your player of the year?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Tennis legends Serena Williams and Carlos Alcaraz teamed up for a brief but thrilling mixed doubles showing at the US Open.**

The star pairing eventually lost their match, but not before delighting the crowds in New York. It was a rare chance to see two generations of tennis talent on the same side of the net.

ON AIR – What a dream team! Who would be your ultimate tennis mixed doubles pairing?

TENNIS · THIS WEEK

4 **Nottingham Forest have agreed a fee worth around £50 million to sign Chelsea striker Liam Delap.**

The young forward is set to make the move to the City Ground in a significant deal for both clubs. Forest will be hoping Delap can provide a boost to their attacking options.

ON AIR – That's a big fee for Delap! Do you think he'll be a success at Forest?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Could a Premier League club break the record for transfer sales in a single window this summer?**

Aston Villa, Manchester City, and Newcastle are all closing in on Monaco's record for transfer income generated. It's been a busy window for player movement.

ON AIR – It's been a summer of big spending and big sales! Which club has done the best business so far?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study suggests that taking up a 'creative hobby' in adulthood can significantly boost mental well-being.**
Researchers found that activities like painting, pottery, or learning a musical instrument helped reduce stress and increased feelings of accomplishment.
- 2 The joy of 'picnics in unexpected places' is growing, with city dwellers finding delightful green spots for an al fresco meal.**
From rooftop gardens to tucked-away park benches, people are rediscovering the simple pleasure of outdoor dining beyond traditional picnic spots.
- 3 Experts say that regularly 'decluttering your digital life' can have a surprisingly positive impact on your focus and mood.**
Organising photos, unsubscribing from unwanted emails, and clearing desktop clutter can create a sense of calm and clarity.
- 4 There's a delightful trend emerging for 'mini libraries' or book swaps in front gardens, fostering community and reading.**
Neighbours are setting up small, weatherproof boxes where people can borrow or swap books, encouraging a love for literature amongst all ages.
- 5 Research shows that 'morning routines' that include a moment of quiet reflection can set a positive tone for the entire day.**
Even just five minutes of mindful breathing or planning your day can help reduce rushing and promote a sense of calm before the day truly begins.
- 6 The charm of 'handwritten notes' is making a comeback, with people rediscovering the personal touch of a physical message.**
In an increasingly digital world, a thoughtful card or letter stands out and can bring a unique warmth to any communication.
- 7 Scientists are exploring the fascinating world of 'plant communication', revealing how plants 'talk' to each other.**
It turns out trees can share nutrients and even warn each other about pests through underground fungal networks, a bit like a hidden internet.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of crisps will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: GIVING THE BAG A LITTLE SHAKE AND LISTENING TO THE CRUNCH.

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, hot cup of tea or coffee, especially when it's a new mug. What is it?

ANSWER: GIVING THE INSIDE A QUICK, IMAGINARY POLISH WITH THEIR THUMB.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a particular 'smell' can instantly transport you back to a specific memory or a moment from your past?

Perhaps it's the smell of freshly cut grass reminding you of childhood summers, or a particular perfume that brings back a special person. What's that scent for you, and where does it take you?

- We all have those 'little everyday moments of satisfaction' that just make us feel quietly pleased, don't we?

It could be getting all the laundry folded in one go, finding a perfectly ripe avocado, or getting a tricky knot out of a shoelace. What's a small victory that recently brought a smile to your face?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** The footprints left by astronauts on the Moon could remain visible for millions of years because there's no wind or water to erode them.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The first alarm clock could only ring once a day, precisely at 4 AM, no matter what time it was set for.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of flamingos is called a 'flamboyance'.
- Bananas are technically berries, but strawberries are not.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 to 45 minutes.
- Chameleons change their colour not just to blend in, but also to communicate their mood and body temperature.
- The world's oldest known living tree, 'Methuselah', is a Great Basin bristlecone pine over 4,800 years old, located in California.
- You can tell the freshness of an egg by placing it in water; a fresh egg will sink, while an old one will float.
- The word 'robot' comes from the Czech word 'robota', meaning forced labour or drudgery.
- More people live inside the circle of London's M25 motorway than live in the whole of Scotland.

On this day

Day 239 of the year, 126 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Baculus of Sorrento; Christian feast day: Caesarius of Arles; Christian feast day: David Lewis; Christian feast day: Decuman. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1969 — Mark Ealham, English cricketer
- 1942 — Daryl Dragon, American keyboard player and songwriter (died 2019)
- 1985 — Kevan Hurst, English footballer
- 1981 — Patrick J. Adams, Canadian actor
- 1975 — Mase, American rapper, songwriter and pastor
- 1948 — John Mehler, American drummer
- 1961 — Mark Curry, English television host and actor
- 1947 — Barbara Bach, American actress and model

THE DAY TODAY

- 1955 — The first edition of the Guinness Book of Records is published in Great Britain.
- 1975 — The Governor of Portuguese Timor abandons its capital, Dili, and flees to Atauro Island, leaving control to a rebel group.
- 1979 — The Troubles: Eighteen British soldiers are killed at the Warrenpoint ambush by the Provisional Irish Republican Army near Warrenpoint, Northern Ireland, in the deadliest attack on British forces during Operation Banner. An IRA bomb also kills British royal family member Lord...

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2009 — Internal conflict in Myanmar: The Burmese military junta and ethnic armies begin three days of violent clashes in the Kokang Special Region.
- 1992 — Aeroflot Flight 2808 crashes on approach to Ivanovo Yuzhny Airport, killing all 84 aboard.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1982 — Turkish military diplomat Colonel Atilla Altıkat is shot and killed in Ottawa. Justice Commandos of the Armenian Genocide claim to be avenging the massacre of 1+½ million Armenians in the 1915 Armenian genocide.

1991 — The European Community recognizes the independence of the Baltic states of Estonia, Latvia and Lithuania.

- 1939 — First flight of the turbojet-powered Heinkel He 178, the world's first jet aircraft.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 240 of the year, 125 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alexander of Constantinople; Christian feast day: Augustine of Hippo; Christian feast day: Edmund Arrowsmith; Christian feast day: Florentina. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1970 — Rick Recht, American singer-songwriter
- 1943 — Robert Greenwald, American director and producer
- 1982 — Kevin McNaughton, Scottish footballer
- 1945 — Bob Segarini, American-Canadian singer-songwriter (died 2023)
- 1925 — Billy Grammer, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2011)
- 2000 — Marissa Bode, American actress
- 1962 — Paul Allen, English footballer
- 1956 — Steve Whiteman, American singer-songwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1998 — Second Congo War: Loyalist troops backed by Angolan and Zimbabwean forces repulse the RCD and Rwandan offensive on Kinshasa.
- 2009 — NASA's Space Shuttle Discovery launches on STS-128.
- 1993 — The autonomous Croatian Community of Herzeg-Bosnia in Bosnia and Herzegovina is transformed into the Croatian Republic of Herzeg-Bosnia.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1955 — Black teenager Emmett Till is lynched in Mississippi for whistling at a white woman, galvanizing the nascent civil rights movement.
- 1944 — World War II: Marseille and Toulon are liberated.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar